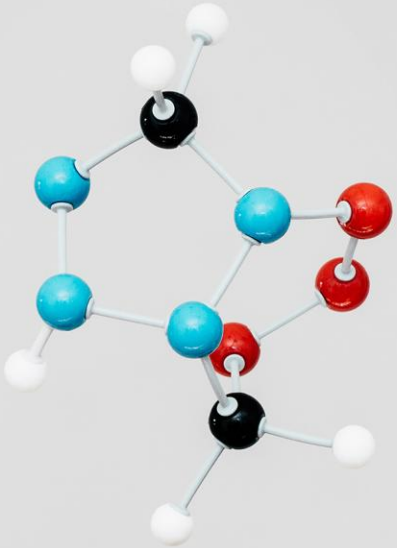


GRAMMAR & BASICS

Session 1

Tenses

Course Set-up

Two sessions per week

2) Work sessions (leerplein).

Work sessions with all groups:

you can work on self-study topics, ask teachers questions about that week's topics, work on speaking (get feedback) or on writing/culture assignments.

1) Lecture
Lectures with stem-group:
explanation, discussion and practice of a grammatical topic

Done with attendance?

1. Fill in the form for me to learn your names:

Link also in Teams!

2. Activating prior knowledge:

In pairs: What verb tenses do you know in your native language and do you know the English equivalents?

Fill in Attendance:
https://forms.office.com/e/9xF4TLDXZZ

Today we focus on:

The Present & The Past

Present simple – Usage I

- To talk about things that are true in general
  - I **work** at Hogeschool Utrecht.
  - I **teach** English for a living.

- To talk about things that are true all the time (facts)
  - The earth **goes** around the sun.
  - Water **boils** at 100 degrees Celsius.

Present simple – signal words

- I **go** to school <u>every day</u>.
- She <u>usually</u> **reads** a book after dinner.

Signal words: every.., each, usually, every day,

Present continuous

Unfinished or current actions

- He **is getting** dressed.
- He **is looking** around.

- Notice how these sentence would answer the question:
- “What is he doing <u>right now</u>?”

Present continuous –signal words

- Words indicating a current action:
  - (right) now, at the moment, look!, listen!

- Words indicating a period around now:
  - today, this week, this year

More examples

- Current actions
  - I **am teaching** [at the moment].
- Limited duration
  - I **am working** at a pizza place [only for the summer].
- Actions around the time of speaking
  - She **is reading** The Hunger Games [these days before going to sleep, even if she's not literally doing it at this moment].

Present Tenses Compared

Side-by-side comparison

Present Simple	Present Continuous
It **rains** a lot in this country.	It **is raining** [now]. Let's stay in.
My parents **live** in London.	I **am living** with some friends [until I find a flat].
He **works** hard <u>most of the time</u>.	He **is working** very hard [today].
Water **freezes** at 0 degrees C.	It **is freezing** outside [at the moment].

Worksheet

- Exercise 1
- Exercise 2

Exercise 1: Fill in the correct form, choose **present simple** or **present continuous**

1. John **(PLAY)** football at the moment. is playing
2. We often **(TAKE)** tests at our school. take
3. I **(TALK)** to my teacher now. am talking
4. Look! Mandy and Susan **(WATCH)** a film on TV. are watching
5. Olivia **(VISIT)** her uncle every weekend. visits
6. Now the sun **(SHINE)**. is shining
7. They **(READ)** poems in the lessons sometimes. read
8. Listen! The band **(TEST)** the new guitar. is testing (American) / are testing (British)
9. First I **(WASH)**, then I dress. wash
10. Every morning my mother **(GET)** up at 6 o'clock gets

Exercise 2: Fill in the correct form, choosing from **present simple** and **present continuous** (mind the questions and negatives)

2

1. Every Monday, Sally **(DRIVE)** her kids to football practice. drives
2. Usually, I **(WORK)** as a secretary at ABT, but this summer I **(STUDY)** French at a language school in Paris. That is why I am in Paris. work / am studying
3. He **(not / HAVE)** enough time to do everything. That is why he **(NEED)** me doesn't have / needs
4. I'm sorry I can't hear what you **(SAY)** because everybody **(TALK)** so loudly. are saying / is talking
5. Don't forget to take your umbrella. It **(RAIN).** is raining
6. What **(she / THINK)** of this situation? does she think
7. **(you / ENJOY)** yourselves? Yes, that's why we **(COME)** here all the time. Are you enjoying / come

Now You!

Go to wooclap.com and use the code MNEHHS
0 are confused
Write one sentence using the signal word + a one-line WHY....
1 Usually
2 Right now
Click on the projected screen to start the question
wooclap
90%
0

Comparing two new tenses:

“I **have done** that” vs. “I **did** that”

Present/Past Tenses Compared

Past Simple Rule

- **Completed** action in past
- I lived in Groningen for 8 years

Present Perfect Rule

- Action started in past and is still true (or at least noticeable) now
- I have lived in Utrecht for 6 years

Past simple - When

- When there is an expression **indicating past time**
  - I **worked** at Hogeschool Rotterdam <u>five years ago</u>. [not anymore]
  - They **went** to school <u>yesterday</u>. [It's not yesterday anymore]
  - Shakespeare **died** <u>in 1616</u>. [It's not 1616 anymore]
  - I **saw** John <u>5 minutes ago</u>. [It's not 5 minutes ago anymore]

- To indicate that something is finished.
  - I **lived** in Groningen for 8 years. [I don't live there anymore]
  - He **worked** at that office for a couple of months. [not now]

Past simple – Signal words

- Any expression indicating past time
  - Yesterday, earlier, … ago, last …, in (+ time in the past), when …, specific dates

Present Perfect

- I **have worked** at Hogeschool Utrecht <u>for four years now.</u>
- He **has lived** in the Netherlands <u>all his life.</u>

- *Often the tense “has lived” / “have done” etc. indicate “so far” or “…and still counting”.

Present Perfect

- Anything from the past until now that is **not** finished
  - I **have lived** in Utrecht for 6 years. [so far this is s still true]
  - He **has** never **been** to Spain. [still true]

- Also actions in the past that have a result now
  - I **have forgotten** her name. [and I still can't remember it now]
  - She **has lost** her key. [and she still doesn't have it now]

- But: when the action is over and/or a time expression is used you use the past form
  - She **lost** her key, but she found it again.
  - She **lost** her key yesterday.

Present Perfect – Signal words

- Words indicating how long:
  - Since (+ moment in time) → since Monday, since June
  - For (+ duration) → for weeks, for 5 years
    - BUT only if it has not finished! If it's done, then use Past Simp
    - "They lived there for 5 years, but then they moved away."

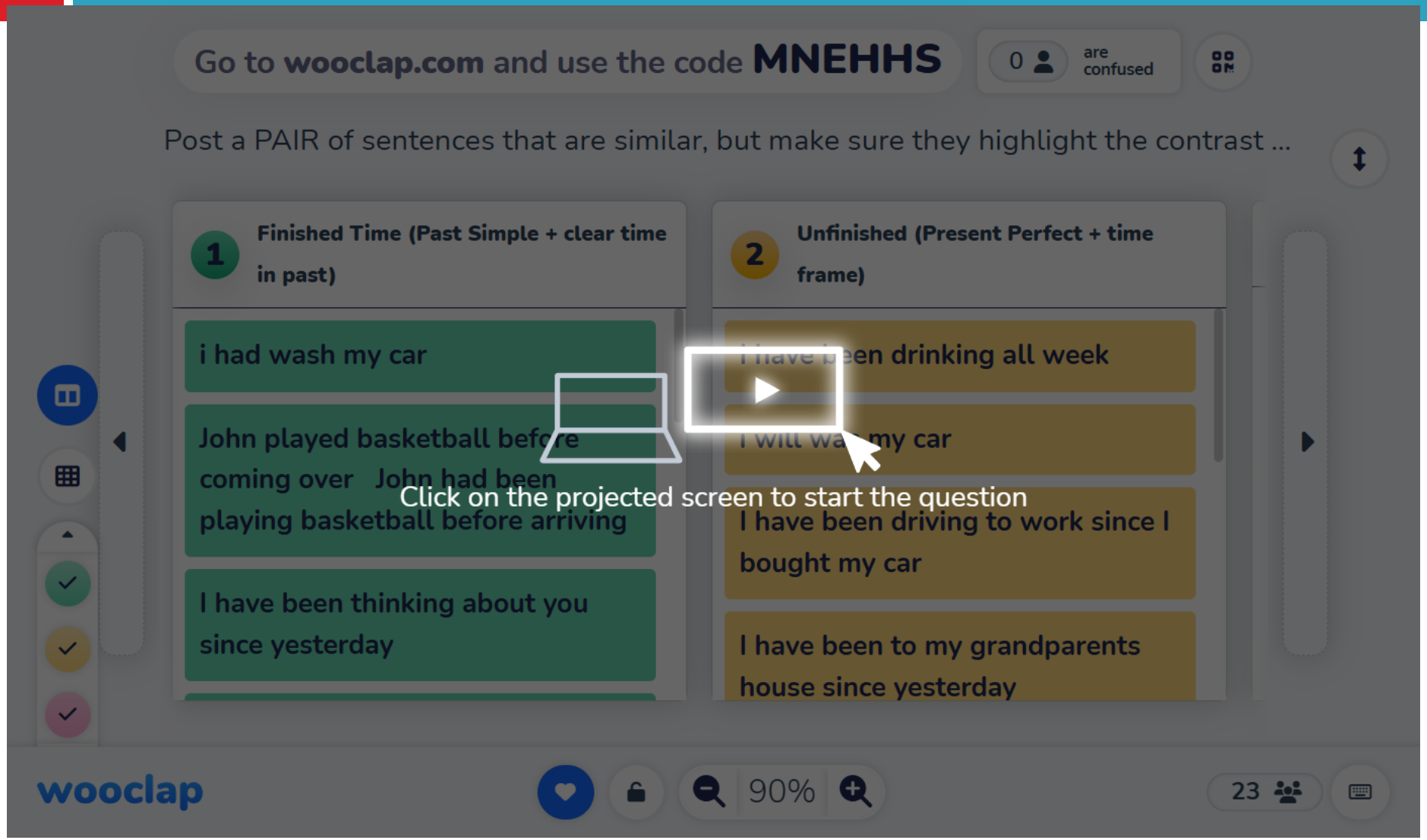
Present perfect & Past simple
Side by side comparison

Past Simple	Present Perfect
I **lived** in Groningen for 8 years.	I **have lived** in Utrecht for 6 years.
I **was** at school last week.	I **have been** at school since this morning.
He **painted** the door last week.	He **has painted** the door, so don't touch it.
She **broke** her leg when she was 12.	She **has broken** her leg and can't walk for a while

Worksheet

Exercise 3

Now You!


Go to wooclap.com and use the code MNEHHS
0 are confused
Post a PAIR of sentences that are similar, but make sure they highlight the contrast ...
1 Finished Time (Past Simple + clear time in past)
2 Unfinished (Present Perfect + time frame)
i had wash my car
John played basketball before coming over John had been playing basketball before arriving
I have been thinking about you since yesterday
I have been drinking all week
my car
I have been driving to work since I bought my car
I have been to my grandparents house since yesterday
Click on the projected screen to start the question
wooclap
90%
23

Exercise 3: Choose the correct form.

3

1. Peter **played/has played** football yesterday.
2. They **cleaned/have cleaned** the car. It looks new again.
3. They **bought/have bought** the car in 2011.

3 (cont.)

4. Last year we **went/have gone** to Italy.
5. I haven't seen Paul since I **arrived/have arrived**.
6. I **never visited/have never visited** Greece.
7. I **saw/ have seen** my friend two days ago.
8. The girls **didn't have/ haven't had** their lunch yet.
9. I **lost/have lost** my key, so I can't open the door
10. Columbus **arrived/has arrived** in the new world by accident

Past tenses - Review

- We've already seen two forms to talk about the past
  - For things that are finished (past only) →
    I worked there for 4 years
  - For things that are not finished (from past until now) →
    I have worked there for 4 years
- There are two other forms that are used, especially in combination with the normal past form

Two things happening in the past

One after another

- Sometimes one event happens after another.
  - He **arrived** after I **had left**
  - I **had called** her before I **heard** she wasn't home.
- The event that happened first chronologically (not necessarily first in the sentence!) gets another form:
- (We usually call it 'past perfected' but you don't need to know these terms for the test)

Two things happening in the past

One after another

- Sometimes you can only tell from the verb form which happened first
  - When the police arrived the thieves **had left** the building
  - When the police arrived the thieves **left** the building

Two things happening in the past

At the same time

- BUT, sometimes two things in the past happened <u>at the same time. In this case the past continuous is used.</u>
- Often one <u>longer</u> action interrupted by a <u>shorter</u> action
  - While I **was having** a bath the phone **rang.**
  - I **was cutting** the grass when suddenly I **hurt** my back.
- You can also use them the other way around
  - When I **saw** Mike I **was cycling** home.

Longer actions in the past

- Besides using a phrase like ‘when I saw Mike’ we can also use expressions that indicate a time in the past
  - At 5 o’clock I **was** [in the process of] **cycling** home
  - Yesterday evening I **was** [in the process of] **watching** TV.
- i.e., when you’re in the middle of an action

Worksheet

Exercise 4

Exercise 5

Exercise 4: Choose the correct form.

1. My team **has won/has been winning** two matches so far.
2. They **had waited/had been waiting** for 90 minutes when the train finally arrived
3. Gene Kelly caught the flu because he **had sung/had been singing** in the rain too long.
4. Aren't we there yet? We **have walked/have been walking** for hours.
5. But we **have only covered/have only been covering** an area of five miles so far.
6. She was very tired in the evening, because she **had marked/had been marking** 25 portfolios.
7. He **had written/had been writing** 15 pages when he decided to take a break.
8. I **have worked/have been working** on this essay since two o'clock.
9. Jane **has gone out/ has been going out** with Bob for seven years
10. Their legs were sore, because they **had cycled/had been cycling** 200 miles.

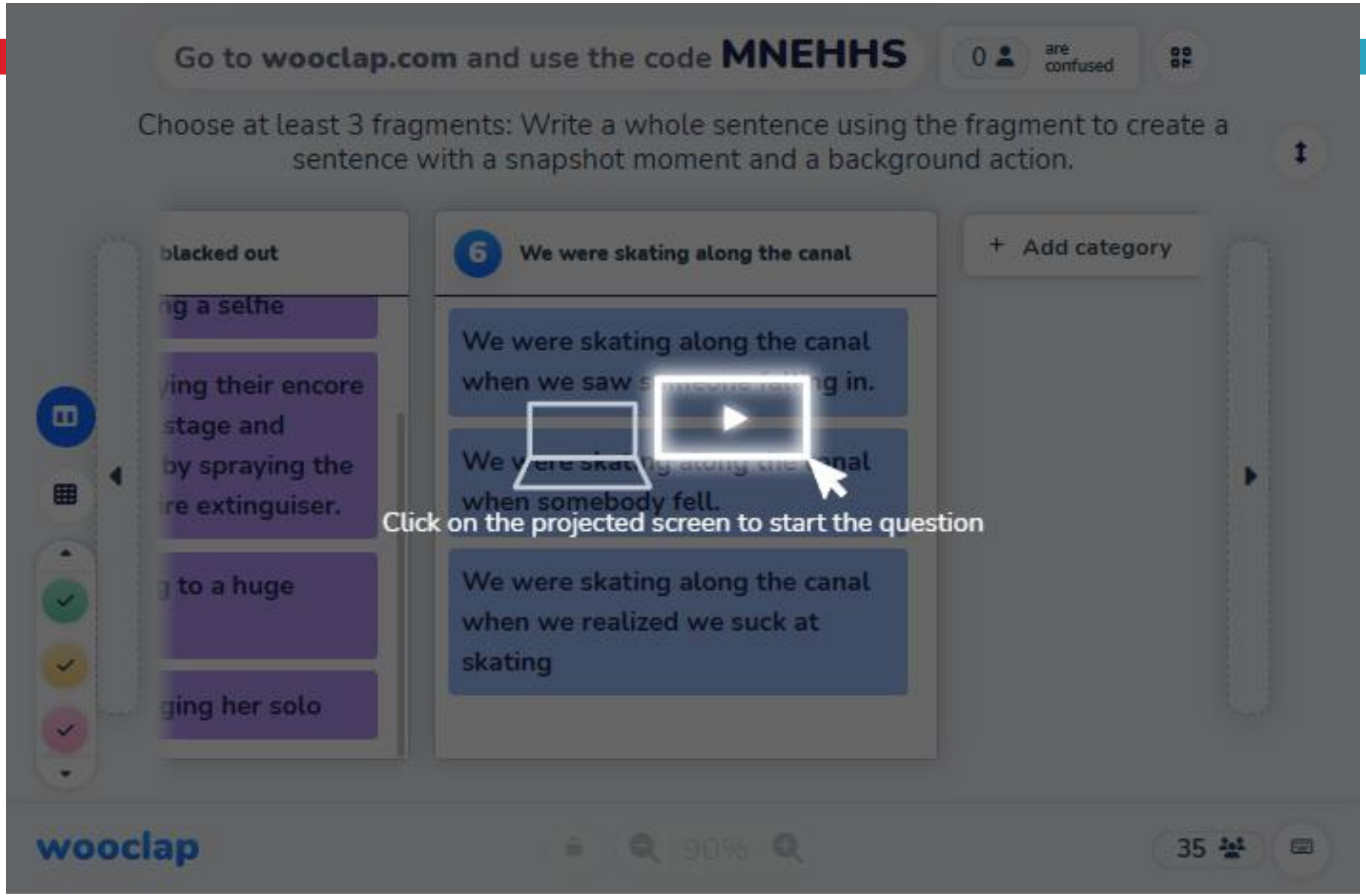
4

Exercise 5: Fill in the correct form, choosing from past simple, past continuous or past perfect simple

5

1. I **(WATCH)** was watching a cookery program on TV when I **(REALIZE)** realized how hungry I was.
2. That was because I **(not / EAT)** had not eaten anything since lunch.
3. I **(GO)** went into the kitchen, **(OPEN)** opened the fridge and **(CHECK)** checked what was inside.
4. While I **(LOOK)** was looking for something good, my stomach **(GROWL)** growled/was growling (both OK).
5. I **(CRAVE)** was craving the leftovers from yesterday, but somebody **(TAKE)** had taken them.
6. I **(SETTLE)** settled for some fruit, but as I **(EAT)** was eating it, I **(SEE)** saw the leftovers in the trash.
7. My brother **(COME)** came in and **(CONFESS)** confessed he **(THROW)** had thrown them away

Now You!


Go to wooclap.com and use the code MNEHHS
0 are confused
Choose at least 3 fragments: Write a whole sentence using the fragment to create a sentence with a snapshot moment and a background action.
blacked out
6 We were skating along the canal
+ Add category
g a selfie
ing their encore
stage and
by spraying the
re extinguiser.
to a huge
ging her solo
We were skating along the canal when we saw
g in.
We were skating along the canal when somebody fell.
We were skating along the canal when we realized we suck at skating
Click on the projected screen to start the question
wooclap
90%
35